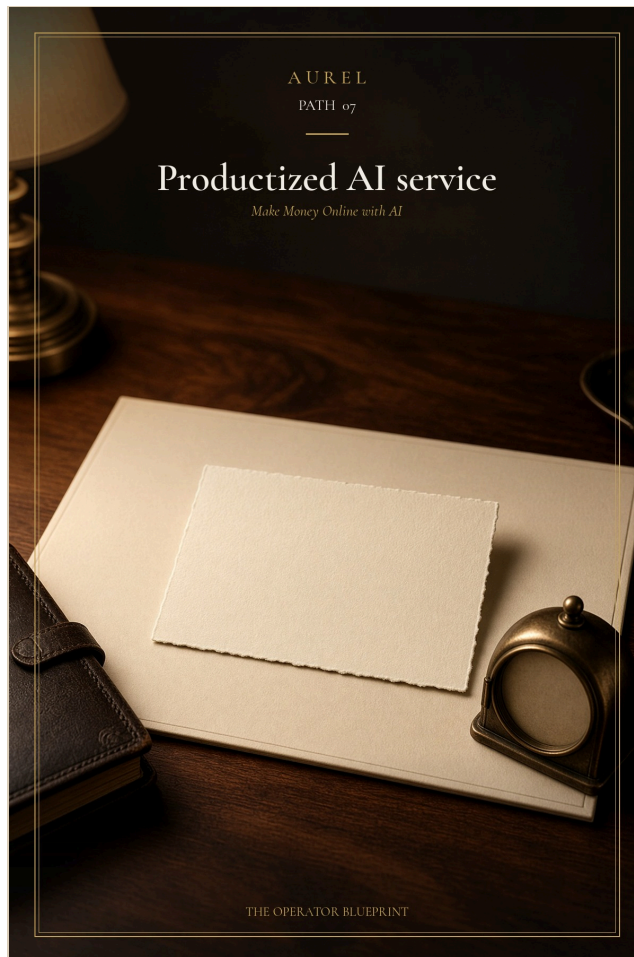




PATH 07

Productized AI service

Do not sell hours. Sell a named package with a date on it.

37 minute read · 8,224 words

Who this is for

You can get a result for someone else in a known number of days, using AI for draft and you for quality.

Time to first

3–14 days with outreach

Tools

First sale

One paid package with a written scope. Deposit in, date on a calendar.

Cash window

\$300–\$1,500 first packages. \$600 is the honest middle.

Leave this alone

Calendly, Stripe invoice or deposit link, a one-page agreement, a kickoff form.

A menu of 12 services. Unlimited revisions. Custom everything. Free discovery hours.

Why this prints cash faster than a file

A service is slower to scale and faster to cash. If you need money this month, this path beats a playbook. You will still take notes. Those notes become the file you sell later.

Do not sell hours. Sell a named package with a date on it. Hours train people to haggle your Tuesday. A package trains them to say yes or no.

Definition, in one breath The package has a name, a deliverable, a timeline, a price, and a definition of done. “I’ll help with your AI” is not a package. “12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600” is. You can hold the second one in your hand. You can put it on a calendar. You can take a deposit against it.

You run AI internally. You edit until it sounds like them. They never see the raw model output. They get files in a folder they own, a 15-minute walkthrough, and one revision window. That is the product. The date is part of the product. Without a date it is hours with extra branding.

What this is not It is not a retainer with vague “AI support.” It is not a menu of twelve services. It is not unlimited revisions. It is not custom everything. Those are how a \$600 job becomes a \$600 relationship that eats your month.

It is not a free discovery call that becomes the job. It is not a Slack login with no wall. It is not posting for them unless that is in the named package. It is not strategy offsites, brand workshops, or “I’ll just take a look.” Looking is the job. Charge for it or send a cheaper file.

Why this works now Buyers already have a model window. What they do not have is a week of posts that match their offer, on a date, with someone else’s name on the quality. The window is free. The date and the edit pass are not. People who say “AI can do this” are right about the draft. They are wrong about the week. A package sells the week.

This path also works now because files are slow to cash and retainers are slow to start. A named 7-day package sits in the middle: money this month, a wall around the work, notes you can turn into a playbook later.

Three anti-patterns Anti-pattern one: hours. “\$75/hour, let’s see how it goes.” It goes until you resent them and they resent the clock. There is no done.

Anti-pattern two: the menu. Twelve services on a page, each one a conversation. You will explain all twelve and sell none. Narrow is how you keep the date.

Anti-pattern three: unlimited revisions until they love it. Happiness with no wall is a project without a date. One round, written, 48 hours after delivery. After that, a new package or a polite no.

The deal you keep You keep the date, or you tell them before it slips. You keep AI internal. You keep one package this week. You keep a deposit before you open a chat. You keep a folder they own. You keep one revision window. You do not keep a menu, a free hour, or a Slack that never ends. The deal is a named result by a named day for a named price.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This path fits if you can get a result for someone else in a known number of days, using AI for draft and you for quality. You need one job you have finished more than twice. You need the spine to take a deposit before you open a chat.

Fits if People already ask you to “just look at this.” You can name what “done” looks like without a two-hour discovery call. You can keep a 7-day or 14-day date. You are willing to write a one-page agreement that fits on a phone. You have shipped the result for yourself — a week of posts, a landing draft, a set of emails — at least twice.

You can send ten asks to people who already trust you. You can say no to a sixth round of “quick tweaks.” You can estimate hours well enough to know the package fits in a week. You do not

need a portfolio site. You need one page, a deposit link, and a spine.

Skip if You freeze when someone asks what it costs. You want to be available for any AI problem. You cannot say no to extra rounds. You have never shipped the result for yourself. Do not sell a week of posts if you have never posted a week.

Skip it if you only want to sell files and never talk to a buyer. Use the playbook or template path. This path is faster cash because a human is in the loop. That human is you. Plan for that.

Skip it if you need a team, a brand film, or a 12-item menu before you will ask. Skip it if you will work before the deposit “just this once.” That once becomes the business.

The honest middle Most people who stall here can do the job and cannot name the package. They wait for a perfect niche, a website, a case study. The first seat is the case study. The one-pager is the website. The niche is the job you have already finished twice.

You will talk to humans. Not all day. Kickoff form, midpoint sample, 15-minute walkthrough, one revision. That is the conversation. If even that feels like too much people, this is the wrong path this month. Sell a file. Come back when you need cash faster.

Skills and time Skills: write a one-line offer. Run a kickoff form. Draft with a model. Edit until it sounds like them. Keep a date. Send an invoice. Ask for a referral in one sentence. Write a two-page SOP after job one.

Time: 3–14 days to first paid seat with outreach. Day 1 is the one-pager and the rails. Days 2–4 are ten asks. Days 5–7 (or 5–14) are the first job if someone says yes. The job itself is a week of your calendar, not a month of “when I have time.”

Budget: Calendly free tier, Stripe, a Google Doc for the agreement. Under \$50 to start if you already have a model window.

Two-minute self-test Answer these out loud.

What is the deliverable in one line, with a number on it?

How many days from deposit to folder?

What is the price you can say without coughing?

Have you shipped this result for yourself at least twice?

Who are ten people who already trust you, that you can message this week?

If you have the line, the days, the price, the two reps, and ten names, write the one-pager this morning. If you cannot name the deliverable, you do not have a package. Pick one job. Split the rest.

The offer, named in one sentence

Write this before you design a logo: “[Name of package]: [deliverable] in [days] for [price]. You get files, not a login to my brain. One revision window. Deposit holds the seat.”

Sam’s sentence is the model: 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600. You can swap the deliverable. You cannot swap the specificity. If you cannot fit the offer on one line, you have two packages. Split them, then pick one.

Five example sentences that work 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600. For a one-person shop that already knows what they sell.

8 client follow-up emails and a one-page FAQ in 5 days for \$450. For a tutor or coach who hates restating the same answers.

A 4-page onboarding kit (welcome, timeline, invoice, FAQ) in 7 days for \$800. For a tradesperson who still sends Word docs.

15 product descriptions and a category intro in 10 days for \$900. For a shop owner with a catalog and no time.

A 7-day content week plus a weekly review prompt in 7 days for \$500. For someone who bought a calendar template and still will not fill it.

The number is in the sentence. The days are in the sentence. The price is in the sentence. The buyer is in the next breath. If the buyer is “anyone using AI,” you will spend intake explaining

what you do.

What they get They get the named deliverable in a folder they own. They get one revision window with a clock. They get a 15-minute walkthrough. They get a date. They get your edit pass — the part a model will not do. They get a kickoff form so they do not have to perform their business on a call. They get files they keep if you disappear.

What they do not get They do not get a strategy offsite. They do not get a brand workshop. They do not get you managing their accounts. They do not get a second landing page. They do not get unlimited voice notes. They do not get posting unless it is in the sentence. They do not get a shared chat with the model. They do not get hours. Write the “not in” list on the one-pager. Buyers relax when they see the walls.

Packaging One package. One line. Deposit holds the seat. Half is clean: \$300 of \$600, or whatever your number is. The rest on delivery, before the revision window or after the walkthrough.

A first-seat discount is allowed once, if you need a named example: \$400 instead of \$600, with permission to describe the result. After that seat, full price. Do not run a sale. Do not add a second package this week because the first ten were quiet.

If they fail intake — no offer, no examples, no ability to post — send a cheaper file. Do not invent their business inside a \$600 week.

What ‘done’ looks like

Done is one paid package with a written scope. Not a maybe. Not a “we’ll figure it out on a call.” Money in, scope on a page, date on a calendar. Folder delivered. Walkthrough held. Revision window opened and closed. Referral asked. SOP written. That is a finished first seat.

Definition of done The one-pager exists. The rails work (Calendly, deposit link, agreement). Ten asks went out. A deposit arrived before you started. The deliverable is in a folder they own. They never saw raw model output. You kept the date, or you told them before it slipped. You asked for a referral the day they were happy. You wrote what you actually did so job two is faster.

The fairness test Would you buy this package with your own money if you had their Tuesday problem? If you would not, the deliverable is vague or the date is a wish. Fair also means the “not in” list was on the page before they paid. Fair means a refund of unused work if they are a bad fit, not extra scope to “make it right” while you are angry. Fair means they can open the files without you after the walkthrough.

Technical done - One-pager: who, in, out, days, price, deposit, revision clock, what they must provide - Kickoff form sent after deposit - AI run internally; edited; midpoint sample on the stated day - Folder they own (Drive, Notion, zip) - 15-minute walkthrough, not a second project - One revision window, dated - Balance collected - SOP of what you asked, which prompts you used, where you edited, how long it took

Not-done-yet list You are not done if you are still “hopping on a call to see.” You are not done if there is no deposit. You are not done if the deliverable is “help with AI.” You are not done if they have a Slack login and no date. You are not done if you skipped the SOP. You are not done if you discounted seat two because seat one felt awkward. You are not done if you have two packages on the page. Ship one. Then write the SOP. Then book the next seat at full price.

Price, deposit, and the first-seat discount

First packages live at \$300–\$1,500. Under \$300 you will attract people who want a miracle and a friend. Over \$1,500 on job one, you will invent a process during a job that is too expensive to

fumble. Sam's \$600 for a 7-day content-and-landing package sits in the honest middle: real money, finishable week.

Ranges \$300–\$450 — first-seat discount, or a smaller package (emails, a one-pager, 8 posts). Not a habit.

\$600–\$800 — the default first full-price package. A week of work you can keep. 7 to 10 days.

\$1,000–\$1,500 — after the SOP is real and you are full, or a clearly larger deliverable (onboarding kit, catalog copy). Still one package, still a date.

Above \$1,500 on this path in month one is how you freeze and over-promise. Raise later, inside the same range, or add a week of wait.

When to raise Raise after three jobs delivered on time at the current price, with an SOP that made job three faster than job one. Raise \$200 at a time, or add wait instead of money if you are full and scared of the new number. Do not raise because a thread said \$3,000 is the floor. Do not lower because a stranger flinched. Send the cheaper file to the flinch.

Refunds in one sentence If they are a bad fit after deposit and you have not started, refund in full. If you have started, keep the deposit, refund unused work, stop. Do not work angry to “make it right” with extra scope.

What you never charge You never charge hours on this path. You never charge a “discovery fee” that is actually the job unpaid. You never add unlimited Slack as a \$50 line item — that is hours with extra typing. You never take the whole \$600 after delivery with no deposit. You never discount seat two because you felt awkward on the walkthrough.

Worked dollars Sam: first seat \$450 (case-study discount), deposit \$225, balance \$225, 7 days, tutoring practice. Next seat \$600, referral from the tutor, week three. Two jobs in three weeks: \$1,050 before fees. Hours actually spent: about 9

on job one, about 6 on job two after the SOP. That is \$117/hour on job one if you insist on dividing, but you are not selling hours. You are selling a week of posts and a page. The SOP is what makes job two pay better without raising the price yet.

Your first \$600 at full price, kept on date, with a referral ask, is the milestone. Do not despise \$600. It is rent-adjacent. It is also inventory for the playbook.

The first 72 hours

You do not need a portfolio site. You need one page, ten asks, and a way to take money.

Day 1 morning: write the package on one page Who it is for. What is in. What is not. Timeline. Price. What they must provide (voice notes, old posts, offer, deadline, three examples they like, words they refuse). How many revisions (one is enough). Deposit. Where the files will live. Put your name and a start date like “next Monday if the deposit is in by Friday.”

Write it so a tired person can forward it. If you add a second package this morning, you will explain both and sell neither.

Day 1 afternoon: the rails Calendly for a 15-minute kickoff or walkthrough — not a free hour. Stripe invoice or deposit link. A one-page agreement that repeats the package page in slightly drier words. A kickoff form: assets, voice, deadline, examples they like, words they hate, the offer the posts must serve. Test the payment link with a dollar if you need to know it works.

Put the package link in the Calendly invite. If they need longer than 15 minutes, they need a different product.

Day 1 night: name the ten Write ten names. People who have asked you for help, hired you adjacent, or complained about the exact job. Not a cold list. Not a group you lurk in. Ten is an evening of messages, not a campaign. If you cannot name ten, name six and ship anyway. Do not spend the night designing a logo.

Day 2: ten asks Send the package to those ten. Personal notes. One discounted first seat only if you truly need a case, and say so out loud: “First seat \$400, I can use the result as a named example (you can say no to the name).”

When they say yes, take the deposit before you open a chat window.

Then intake. Then you start — on the date in the one-pager, not before.

Do not post a menu. Do not add a second package because the first ten were quiet by evening.

Day 3: either start, or keep the page If a deposit landed, send the form, book the 15-minute kickoff, start the clock from the deposit, not from the fifth follow-up. If nobody said yes, you still have a page. Send two more asks if you have names. Do not rebuild the offer. Three to fourteen days with outreach is the window, not three hours of hoping.

If you already know you will need the first-seat discount to get a yes this week, send that version on Day 2, once, to the person most likely to let you describe the result. Do not discount all ten.

The path, step by step

Fourteen steps. One package all the way through. If you have two, you have none.

Step 1. One package Name, deliverable, days, price. Write it so a tired person can forward it. Put the “not in” list under it. If you add a second package this week, you will explain both and sell neither. Sam’s line is enough: 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600.

Step 2. Intake: problem, budget, ability to implement If they have no problem you can name, no budget for \$300–\$1,500, or no ability to post what you make, stop. Send them the cheaper file instead. A buyer who cannot implement will blame the posts. The form is how you learn this before you start, not during the revision round.

Step 3. Deposit, then chat Invoice or deposit link first. Kickoff after. Working before the deposit is how “quick questions” become the whole job, unpaid. Half is clean. The date starts when the deposit clears, not when they said “sounds good” in a DM.

Step 4. Kickoff form, not a 45-minute call Assets, voice, deadline, examples they like, words they refuse, the offer the posts must serve. A form beats a call you have to transcribe. The 15-minute Calendly is for questions the form did not catch, then you hang up. If they need a workshop, they need a different product.

Step 5. You run AI internally Draft in a tool they do not sit in. Edit until it sounds like them, not like a model. They never see the raw output. If a line is wrong, it is your line. Cut hype. Check facts they gave you. Match their examples. A landing draft that could belong to any business is not done.

Step 6. Midpoint check, short A screenshot or three sample posts on day 3, not a new scope. If they want a different product, that is a different package after this one. The midpoint is how you avoid using the revision round to change the offer. If they go silent, you still keep the date. Note the silence. Do not add work.

Step 7. Delivery in a folder they own Google Drive, Notion, a zip — they keep it if you disappear. No hostage login. Name the files like a human. Include a one-page “post this first” note so the walkthrough is not a treasure hunt.

Step 8. A 15-minute walkthrough Show them where things live and what to post first. Then stop. The walkthrough is not a workshop. Calendly with a hard wall. If they want another 45 minutes, that is a new package or a no.

Step 9. One revision window Written dates. “One round, 48 hours after delivery.” After that, a new package or a polite no. If you need three rounds to make it good, your midpoint check is missing or you skipped the form. Do not buy peace with extra rounds. You will teach the next buyer that the wall is fake.

Step 10. Ask for the referral while they are happy The day of the walkthrough, not a month later. One sentence. One ask. “If someone you know needs this package this month, send them the page. I have one seat left in [week].”

Step 11. Write the SOP What you asked for, which prompts you used, where you edited, how long it actually took. The second job should be faster. If it is not, you did not write the SOP. You remembered vibes. Two pages. Same week. Before you book seat two.

Step 12. Full price, no discount The first seat may have been cheaper. This one is not, unless you have a reason you can say out loud. Book the next seat before you invent package two.

Step 13. Notes toward a file Every job throws off a playbook chapter, a template, or a letter issue. Capture the prompt stack and the folder structure. Do not pause the package to write the book unless you are full. The package prints cash this month. The file can wait.

Step 14. When you are full, raise or wait Do not hire a stranger to talk to your buyers on job four. Raise inside \$300–\$1,500 or add a week of wait. A menu of twelve is still the wrong answer when you are busy. Busy is the point.

Worked example: Sam’s \$600 week

Sam writes for small service businesses on the side of a day job. People kept asking for “help with AI content.” That sentence made Sam tired. Sam named a package instead: 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600. Files in a folder. One revision. Deposit holds the seat.

This is a three-week story with dollars, a shipped folder, a mistake, a recovery, and a stranger sale.

The one-pager (Monday) Who: a one-person shop that already knows what they sell and needs a week of posts plus a page that does not sound like a brochure. In: 12 posts (mix of short updates and two longer notes), one landing draft (headline, sections, FAQ, closing ask), one revision, 15-minute walkthrough. Not in: posting for them, a logo, a second offer, strategy calls. They must provide: offer, three examples they like, words they hate, any photos they already have, a deadline if a launch is real. Timeline: 7 days from deposit. Price: \$600. Deposit: \$300. Revision: one round, 48 hours after delivery.

Rails the same day: Calendly 15 minutes, Stripe deposit link, one-page agreement, kickoff form. Sam tested the link with \$1.

The first seat (Tuesday–next Tuesday) Sam sent the page to ten people who had asked for help. One owner of a tutoring practice said yes at \$450 as the case-study seat, with permission to describe the result without student names. Deposit \$225 first. Kickoff form the same day.

The mistake Sam drafted in a private window, then pasted three “raw-ish” samples into the day-3 midpoint email to save time. The owner replied: “This sounds like a press release. I would never say guaranteed results.” Sam had skipped the edit pass on the samples. The owner was right. That is how quality becomes a rumor.

The recovery Sam rewrote the three samples against the owner’s examples before the next morning. Cut “guaranteed.” Matched the short sentences the owner already used on their site. Sent a note: “You were right. Here are the same three, edited. I will not send you raw drafts again.” The owner stayed. Sam put “they never see raw output” at the top of the SOP in bold, because the mistake was the process, not the model.

Day 7: folder in Drive, 15-minute walkthrough, invoice for the \$225 balance. One revision on two posts (a promise that was still too strong, plus a time-of-day the owner does not run sessions).

Done. Shipped artifact: 12 posts, one landing draft, a “post this first” note, in a folder the tutor owns.

After, and the stranger Sam wrote a two-page SOP: form questions, the prompt stack, the edit pass, the folder structure. Hours actually spent: about 9, including the redo of the samples. Next job was \$600, no discount — a referral from the tutor, a bookkeeper Sam had never met. That is the first stranger sale. Deposit \$300, same 7-day clock, same folder shape. Job two took about 6 hours because the SOP existed.

Two jobs in three weeks: \$1,050 before fees. Sam still takes notes for a playbook. The package prints cash this month. The file can wait. Sam did not add a second package. Sam did not hire anyone. Sam asked for the referral on the walkthrough day, which is why the bookkeeper showed up.

Copy you can paste

Say the package. Then stop talking.

Post I have one seat this week: 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600. Files in a folder you own. One revision. Deposit holds the seat. Not a strategy call. If you already know what you sell and you need a week that matches, here is the page: [link].

DM, to ten people who already trust you I have one seat this week for [package] at [price]. Deposit holds it. Here is what is in, what is not, and the date: [link]. If it is not useful, ignore this.

Page hero 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days. You get files, not a login to my brain. \$600. Deposit holds the seat.

Checkout / deposit line \$300 holds the seat. The other \$300 is due on delivery, before the revision window. Kickoff form follows when the deposit clears. I start on the date in the one-pager, not before.

Email 1 — the ask Subject: one seat this week

You have asked me about [job] more than once. I put it in a package so neither of us lives in a chat window: [deliverable] in [days] for [price]. What is in, what is not, and the date are on this page: [link]. Deposit holds it. If it is not useful, no need to reply.

Email 2 — after they say yes Subject: deposit link, then we start

Sending the deposit link now. Kickoff form follows when it clears. I start on the date in the one-pager, not before. One revision, 48 hours after delivery. Folder will live in [Drive / Notion], and you will own it.

Email 3 — midpoint Subject: three samples, day 3

Here are three posts from this week's set. If a promise is too strong or a word is wrong, say so here. This is not a new scope. The rest of the folder still lands on [date].

Refund note You asked to stop. If I have not started, the deposit comes back in full. If I have started, I keep the deposit, refund unused work, and send whatever is already in the folder. I will not add scope to “make it right.” You should see the refund in 5–10 days depending on the processor.

Referral ask (walkthrough day) If someone you know needs [package] this month, send them the page. I have [one] seat left in [week]. I will treat them like I treated you.

First-seat version I am taking one discounted first seat at [lower price] so I can use the result as a named example (you can say no to the name). Same scope, same week. After this, it is [full price].

What not to write “Let’s hop on a quick call and I’ll see how I can help.” That call becomes the job. “Unlimited revisions until you love it.” That is a hostage situation with extra steps. “Custom AI solutions for businesses.” That is a menu with no date.

Week-by-week

This is a 3–14 day path if you already know the job. Treat week one as a job, not a brand launch. Four weeks. Weeks 1–2 are daily.

Week 1, day by day Monday: write the one-pager. Price, deposit, in/out, revision rule, what they must provide. Calendly, Stripe, agreement, kickoff form. Test the link.

Tuesday: list ten names. Send the first five asks. Personal notes. No public menu.

Wednesday: send the other five. One discounted first-seat note only if you truly need a case.

Thursday: if a yes arrived, deposit first, then form, then start the clock. If not, do not rebuild the offer. Use the day to fill the SOP skeleton: form questions, folder shape.

Friday: either you are in a job (draft internally, no raw output) or you send two more asks if you have names. Do not add package two.

Saturday: if in a job, midpoint samples if it is day 3. If not, rest. Do not design a logo.

Sunday: if in a job, edit pass. If not, reread the one-pager cold. Is the deliverable a number. Is the “not in” list visible. Fix those two lines only.

Week 2, day by day Monday: deliver if the date is this day, or keep drafting. Write minutes spent so the SOP is not a guess.

Tuesday: walkthrough 15 minutes. Balance invoice. Revision window starts.

Wednesday: referral ask if you forgot it on the walkthrough. SOP first draft, two pages.

Thursday: revision round if they used it. Close the window if they did not.

Friday: next seat at full price, or ten new asks if nobody is in the pipe. Do not discount because seat one felt awkward.

Saturday: notes toward a file. Prompt stack, folder structure. Do not pause to write a playbook.

Sunday: off, or one public line that names the package without a case you do not have permission for.

Week 3 Same package. Same days. Better SOP. Full price. If you want a second product, make it the playbook from the notes, not a second service that splits your calendar. If you have zero deposits after fourteen days of asks, the page is vague or you asked strangers. Rewrite the one line. Ask people who have the Tuesday problem.

Week 4 Count jobs, days-to-deposit, hours vs SOP, revision use, referrals asked vs received. If job two was not faster, the SOP is a diary. Rewrite it from the minutes. If you are full, raise \$200 or add a week of wait. Do not hire. Do not add a menu.

The quality bar

They should be able to use the files the day you hand them over, without you in the room after the walkthrough. That is the bar.

Below the bar Raw model output in the folder. A landing draft that could belong to any business. Date missed in silence. Three “quick” extra rounds. Files in a login they cannot export. No “not in” list. Kickoff was a 45-minute ramble you did not record. You posted for them as a surprise freebie and now it has no done.

Above the bar Sounds like them. Facts they gave you are checked. Date kept, or they heard before it slipped. One revision, used or expired. Folder they own. 15-minute walkthrough, then stop. Referral asked the same day. SOP written the same week. They never saw the raw window.

Test 1 — the raw-output test If you would be embarrassed to put your name under a paragraph, it does not ship. Models draft. You cut hype, check facts they gave you, and match their examples. Read it out loud. If it sounds like a press release, it is not done.

Test 2 — the date test 7 days means 7 days from deposit, not from the fifth follow-up email. If you cannot keep the date, the package is too big. Cut posts, not honesty. Tell them before the date if you must cut, with their written OK.

Test 3 — the revision test One round. Written. If you need three rounds to make it good, your midpoint check is missing or you skipped the form. Do not buy peace with extra rounds. You will teach the next buyer that the wall is fake.

Test 4 — the folder test They own it. A login you control is not delivery. If the host dies, they still have the words. Export a zip at the end even if they live in Drive.

Test 5 — the stranger-forward test Would they forward the one-pager to a peer without writing a paragraph of explanation? If not, the offer is not a package yet. Fix the sentence, not the logo.

What to count

Count jobs, not vibes.

Week 1 - One-pager live, rails tested (yes/no) - Ten asks sent - Deposits in - Days from first ask to first deposit - Hours spent on rails (should be under 6)

Target: page + ten asks. A deposit in week 1 is a win. Zero deposits is normal if asks went out Wednesday. Rebuild is not a metric.

Day 30 - Paid packages with written scope. First one is the milestone. - Days from ask to deposit. If this is over two weeks, your page is vague or you asked strangers. - Hours you actually spent versus the SOP. If job two is not faster, the SOP is a diary. - Revision use. If every job uses the round to change the offer, intake is broken. - Referrals asked vs referrals received. Asking once, on the happy day, is the whole system.

A good first month is one or two \$600-class jobs delivered on time, not twelve half-sold conversations. Cash: \$450–\$1,200 before fees is a real start.

Day 90 - Three or more of the same package, on date - SOP that a future you could follow - Full price, no discount - At least one referral seat - A decision: raise inside \$300–\$1,500, add wait, or spin a file from the notes - Still one package on the page

Day 90 cash for a serious operator: a few thousand from the same package, lumpy. If you are at zero jobs, you asked the wrong ten or the one-pager has no number on the deliverable.

Ignore these for now A public “AI agency” identity. Hour charts. A second service line. Testimonials you wrote for them. Follower counts. Proposal software you have not earned. Count cash collected and dates kept.

One-line spreadsheet Date asked | date deposit | price | hours | on-date (y/n) | revision used (y/n) | referral asked (y/n) | notes

One row per job. Five minutes after delivery. If job two hours are not down, rewrite the SOP this week.

Objections you will hear

These are the lines. The reply is what you actually send.

“Can we hop on a call first?” You can do a 15-minute Calendly after they have the one-pager, or you can send the cheaper file. A free hour is the job. Reply: “The one-pager is the call. If it still fits, deposit holds the seat and we do 15 minutes on kickoff. If you need a longer look, I can send the \$19 file instead.”

“I need a custom thing.” Custom everything is on the leave-alone list. Reply: “If your job is 80 percent this package, we run this package. If it is 20 percent, I should say no this week rather than invent a second product on your dime.”

“\$600 is a lot for something AI can do.” AI can draft. They are paying for 12 posts and a landing draft that match their offer, in 7 days, with your name on the quality. Reply: “If you want the window, you already have it. This is the week of files, edited, on a date. If that is not useful, ignore the page.”

“Can you just do hours?” No. Hours have no done. Reply: “I do not sell hours. The package is [line]. If you need something smaller, here is the file.”

“Unlimited revisions until I’m happy.” One is enough. Reply: “One round, 48 hours after delivery, written on the page. Happiness with no wall is a project without a date. I mean the wall.”

“I do not have examples or an offer yet.” Then they cannot implement. Reply: “I cannot invent your business inside a \$600 week. If you want a cheaper diagnostic or a playbook, I will send that. This package needs an offer you already have.”

“Can you post for us too?” That is a different dated package, or a no. Reply: “Posting is not in this week. If you want a posting package later, we can date it after this folder lands. I will not slide it in for free.”

“Can I pay after I see the work?” No. Reply: “Deposit holds the seat. I do not start before it clears. The rest is due on delivery. That is the whole money conversation.”

“We might need a second landing page.” Reply: “Not in this package. After we close this one, I can quote a second dated package. I will not add it mid-week.”

What this path feeds

This path is the cash pipe. The notes are the product pipe.

Upstream — what you need before this path You need a job you have finished twice. You need ten people who already trust you. You need a spine for a deposit. You do not need a team, a brand, or a menu. If you have never shipped the result, ship it for yourself this week, then sell the package next week. If you have no one to ask, this path is slow. Use the letter or the front door to find ten, or start with people who already asked you to “just look.”

Downstream — where jobs go next Every job becomes a playbook chapter, a template, or a letter issue. Sam’s 12-post week is a filled calendar someone else might buy as a \$19 file later. Referrals fill the next seats. People who cannot afford \$600 still need a door: send the cheaper file instead of shrinking the package.

Affiliate can sit in the walkthrough: “Here is the tool I draft in; you do not have to buy it.”

Disclosure if you link it. The cut is extra. The package is the engine.

When the SOP is real and you are full, raise the price inside \$300–\$1,500 or add a week of wait, before you hire a stranger to talk to your buyers.

What it needs, and what it does not It needs a named package, a deposit link, a spine. It does not need a menu of 12 services. It does not need a team in month one. It does not need you to pause cash to write the book. Keep the package. Let the file grow in the notes.

Mistakes that eat the week

Each one has a recovery you can do this week.

1. Working before the deposit Then you are a friend with a skill, and friends do not get a date on a calendar. Recovery this week: send the deposit link before the next reply. Do not open the chat until it clears.
2. Unlimited revisions Each round teaches them the first delivery was a suggestion. Recovery this week: write the window on the one-pager and in the next email. Mean it on the current job if the window has not been stated. If you already promised unlimited, finish this job, never write that sentence again.
3. A free call that becomes the job Calendly is for kickoff and walkthrough, 15 minutes, after money or after the one-pager. Recovery this week: cancel the standing “discovery” slot. Put the package link in the invite. Charge or send a file.
4. Delivering unedited AI text They can smell it. Your name is on it. Recovery this week: edit every paragraph still in draft. Add “they never see raw output” to the SOP. If a midpoint already went out raw, rewrite it today like Sam did.
5. A menu of 12 services Narrow is how you keep the date. Recovery this week: delete eleven. One package on the page. Tell anyone in conversation that this is the only seat you are selling this month.
6. Custom everything Starting two packages because you were afraid the first one was too narrow. Recovery this week: pick the one you can keep in 7 days. Park the other.
7. Disappearing into Slack so the job never ends Recovery this week: move the thread to the folder and the form. One revision window. Mute the channel after walkthrough.

8. Hosting files in a place they cannot export Recovery this week: zip the folder. Send the zip. Change the SOP so delivery always includes an export.
9. Discounting seat two because seat one felt awkward Recovery this week: next ask is full price. Say it out loud in the message. Awkward is not a reason.
10. Skipping the referral ask Recovery this week: send the one-sentence ask to anyone who already got a walkthrough. Today.
11. Skipping the SOP Then the path is a string of tired one-offs. Recovery this week: two pages. Form questions, prompt stack, edit pass, folder shape, minutes. Before you book the next seat.
12. Inventing their business because they had no offer Recovery this week: stop. Send a cheaper diagnostic or refund unused work. Do not finish a \$600 week that they cannot implement.
13. Hiring on job one Quality becomes a rumor. Recovery this week: you do the edit pass. Do not hire until the SOP is real and you are full at full price.

Tools (keep them boring)

Calendly, Stripe invoice or deposit link, a one-page agreement. That is enough to take money and a date.

Exact stack - One-pager: Google Doc, Notion, or a site page. Ugly is allowed. - Calendly, 15 minutes, kickoff or walkthrough. - Stripe invoice or deposit link. Tested with a dollar. - Kickoff form: Tally, Google Form, or the same Doc. - Folder they own: Google Drive or a zip. - Model window you already use, internal only. - A notes doc for the SOP.

No agency CRM. No proposal software. No project-management suite for one package. No shared chat with the client as the deliverable.

Setup order 1. Write the one-pager (in, out, days, price, deposit, revision). 2. Stripe deposit link. Test it. 3. Agreement that repeats the one-pager. 4. Kickoff form. 5. Calendly, package link in the invite. 6. Ten asks. 7. After job one, SOP in the notes doc.

What not to buy An agency operating system. A white-label fulfillment team. A \$99/month CRM. A contracts platform with e-sign theater for a one-page agreement. A second model subscription “for clients.” They do not sit in your window.

The \$0 path Google Doc for the page and the agreement. Stripe or even a payment link you already have. Calendar app with a 15-minute hold if Calendly feels like shopping. Google Form. Drive folder. The model you already pay for. Asks through mail you already have. You do not need a site on day 1. You need a link that takes \$300.

Calendly 15-minute kickoff or walkthrough. Not a 60-minute “discovery.” If they need longer, they need a different product.

Stripe Deposit before work. Balance before or at delivery. Do not take payment in a chat app that will not help you when a charge is disputed.

One-page agreement Repeats the one-pager: in, out, date, price, deposit, revision window, where files live, what they must provide. You are not playing lawyer. You are writing the same sentences in a form they can screenshot.

AI Internal. Draft only. You edit. No shared chat with the client as the deliverable.

Leave retainers, agency CRMs, and a stack of proposal software on the shelf until you have delivered the same package three times.

Checklist

Tick this before you start job two.

Package page - One package, one line: deliverable, days, price - Who it is for - What is in - What is not - What they must provide - One revision, with a clock - Deposit amount and what it holds - Definition of done (folder they own, walkthrough) - Start rule (clock starts at deposit)

Rails - Calendly 15 minutes - Stripe invoice or deposit link, tested - One-page agreement - Kickoff form - Folder template named like a human

First job - Ten asks to people who already trust you - One discounted first seat only if you need a case - Deposit before chat - AI internally; they never see raw output - Midpoint sample on the stated day - Delivery on the date - Walkthrough 15 minutes, then stop - Referral ask while they are happy - SOP written the same week - Next seat at full price

Quality - Sounds like them, not like a press release - Facts they gave you are checked - Zip or export they keep if you disappear - “Not in” list was on the page before they paid

FAQ

Short answers. Default at the end of each.

Can I sell two packages if they are related? Not in week one. If you have two, you have none. Deliver the same one three times. Then, maybe, a smaller file for people who fail intake. Default: one package on the page.

What if they want me to post for them too? That is a different dated package, or a no. Do not slide posting into the \$600 week for free. It has no done. Default: say no this week, quote later if you want that product.

Do I need Calendly if we already chat? Yes, or something with a hard 15-minute wall. Chat has no wall. Default: Calendly for kickoff and walkthrough only.

How do I handle a bad fit after they pay? Refund the unused work, keep the deposit if you already started and the agreement says so, and stop. Do not work angry to “make it right” with extra scope. Default: stop, refund unused, no extra rounds.

Can I use their job as a case? Ask on the form. Default to fake names. Sam’s tutor said yes to a nameless description. That is enough. Default: names off unless they tick yes.

What if I miss the 7-day date? Tell them before the date. Cut scope with their written OK, or finish and own it. Silent delay is how you pay in reputation. Default: tell them 24 hours before, in writing.

Is \$300 too low? It can be a first-seat price. As a habit it attracts people who want a friend. Default: \$600–\$800 as soon as the SOP is real.

Should I hire someone to draft? Not until you have an SOP and you are full at full price. Hiring on job one is how quality becomes a rumor. Default: you edit every line in month one.

They want unlimited Slack access. No. Folder, form, one revision window, 15-minute walkthrough. Access without a date is hours with extra typing. Default: no Slack login.

When do I turn this into a playbook? When you have notes from two jobs. The package still sells. The file is extra cash from people who will never hire you. Default: do not pause the package to write the book unless you are full.

What if nobody of the ten says yes? The page is vague or you asked strangers. Rewrite the one line so it has a number, days, and a price. Ask people who have the Tuesday problem. Default: do not add package two. Rewrite, then ten new names.

Can I take 100 percent on delivery, no deposit? No. Deposit holds the seat. No deposit is how “sounds good” never starts, or starts unpaid. Default: half up front.

Do I need a website? No. A Doc that forwards is enough. Default: one page, then a site later if you want, not as a blocker.

What license do they get on the files? They own the words you wrote for them. You own the process and the SOP. They cannot resell the package as a package. Default: one paragraph on the agreement.

Can I use their brand voice forever as a sample? Only with permission. Default: fake the names, keep the texture, ask on the form.

Should I add a retainer after the week? Not as a vague “AI support” monthly. If they want another week, sell the same package again with a new date. Default: same package, new date, not a retainer.